



The gift came with conditions

DRAFT GIFT AGREEMENT / NOT SIGNED

1. Museum name

The Grant Larceny Meridian Museum

2. Collection decisions

Grant may veto future acquisitions

3. Museum director

Artie Ficial must resign within sixty days

Donor signature: _____

Grant Larceny has died at the gala after his private toast. His proposed gift agreement is still unsigned. These are the terms he intended to announce tonight.



An empty bottle in preparation



Object

The Velvet Widow poison bottle /
acquisition lot 73

Label

CYANIDE / POISON

Found

Empty; museum custody band broken

After Grant died, investigators found the acquired bottle empty in the locked cupboard. A split underneath the back of its red custody band had been hidden from a casual front view. Staff had returned the bottle without checking its contents. Investigators removed the damaged band for examination.



What happened to Grant's glass



6:30 / New donor glass, still wrapped



6:32 / Place set; server returns to kitchen



6:44 / Glass collected on service tray



6:46 / Shared punch poured for the toast

Initial lab finding

Cyanide inside Grant's glass

Shared punch and food

No cyanide detected

Grant requested the new donor gift glass for his toast. I unwrapped it at 6:32, set his place and returned to the kitchen over the extra course. Guests were circulating through the salon. At 6:44 I collected it on my tray and kept it with me through the 6:46 pour and toast. These photos come from the event photographer's donor-glass coverage. Signed: Service Manager.



When the bottle was accessible



Recovered bottle / photographed during the investigation

6:20 / room opens	Bottle full; museum custody band intact
6:28 / room closes	Returned without inspection; cupboard locked
Other poison objects	No other bottles brought out or given to guests

Before the walkthrough, Chip applied a new museum custody band and the conservator photographed the full bottle. The museum had not accepted this dangerous acquisition. Grant brought it from his own collection and insisted on a guest preview despite the conservator's objection. At 6:28 staff returned it to the cupboard, which stayed locked until the murder investigation. The hidden split was discovered then. Residue in the bottle matches residue inside his glass.



The glass, not the punch

Grant's glass / inside
CYANIDE DETECTED

Shared punch pitcher
NO CYANIDE DETECTED

Food samples
NO CYANIDE DETECTED

Acquired poison bottle
MIXTURE MATCHES GLASS RESIDUE

Scrap inside Grant's glass
RED PAPER / SILVER FOIL BACKING

The inside of Grant's glass contained cyanide. The food and shared punch were clear. Residue in the acquired bottle matches the residue in his glass. A small scrap found inside the glass has the red paper surface and silver-foil backing of the bottle's red custody band. The comparison photograph follows. Staff secured the guests' belongings after the death. The examination excerpts in the Method accounts are official findings. Read those excerpts as recorded, then the accompanying explanation.



The scrap inside the glass



Left: scrap from inside Grant's glass. Right: the damaged bottle band, with silver backing exposed. Both are red paper backed with silver foil. The museum uses this stock for custody bands and decorative work. The laboratory establishes material similarity, not a unique torn-edge fit or which person placed the scrap in the glass.